

BALLINASCREEN & DESERTMARTIN PARISHES ~ TWENTIETH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME ~ 16th AUGUST 2026

PARISH CONTACT DETAILS

Fr. Peter Madden PPAT
31 Sixtowns Road / Telephone: 02879628376
Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Fr. Michael McCaul CC
50 Tobermore Road, Desertmartin
Telephone: 02879632196
Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

PARISH OFFICES

Ballinascreen: 9 High Street
Phone: 02879628248
Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com
Opening Hours: Monday, Tuesday and
Thursday 8.45am-3.30pm
Wednesday 8.45am-3pm
Desertmartin: St Patrick's Keenought
Phone: 02879797047
Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com
Opening Hours: Wednesday &
Thursday 10.30am - 3pm

FEASTS OF THE WEEK

Mon 17th Aug: Our Lady of Knock
Wed 19th Aug: St John the Evangelist
Thurs 20th Aug: St Bernard
Fri 21st Aug: St Priscilla
Sat 22nd Aug: The Queenship of The
Blessed Virgin Mary

MASSES FOR THIS WEEK

Monday – 17th August
10.00am – Holy Rosary
Tuesday – 18th August
10.00am – St Mary's, Coolcalm
Wednesday – 19th August
10.00am – Holy Rosary Church
Thursday – 20th August
10.00am – St Mary's, Coolcalm
Friday – 21st August
10.00am – St Mary's, Coolcalm
7.30pm – Holy Rosary
SATURDAY 22nd August – Vigil Masses
6.00pm – Holy Rosary Church
7.30pm – St Patrick's, Keenought
SUNDAY 23rd August – Masses
9.00am – St Columba's, Straw
10.00am – St Mary's, Coolcalm
11.00am – St Patrick's, Sixtowns
12.00pm – St Eugene's, Moynoneena

CONFESSIONS

Ballinascreen:
Holy Rosary 5.30pm before Vigil Mass.
Desertmartin:
Keenought, Saturday 6.30pm until 7.10pm.

SVP HELPLINE: 07710838050

SPERRIN FOODBANK: 07543420639

GAMBLING HELPLINE:

Help is available by phoning 02871351329.

LIFELINE:

Tel: 0800 808 8000 www.lifelinehelpline.info

SAFEGUARDING The Diocesan
Designated Liaison Person (DLP) is: Marie
O'Kane. Tel: 07596500793 or email:
dpl@diocese.org

DEATHS

We extend our heartfelt sympathy to the family and relatives of:
Ben Flynn RIP, Corabstown, Co. Westmeath. Beloved husband of Maire
Flynn (Hegarty), Trough.

MONTH'S MIND MASS

The Month's Mind Mass for **Bernadette Hegarty RIP**, St Patrick's Street,
will be held on Friday 28th August at 7.30pm in the Holy Rosary Church.
The Month's Mind Mass for **Joe Joe McGuigan RIP**, Moykeeran, will be
held on Friday 28th August at 7.30pm in the Holy Rosary Church.
The Month's Mind Mass for **Joe Burke RIP**, Glocely Villars, will be held
on Friday 28th August at 7.30pm in the Holy Rosary Church.
The Month's Mind Mass for **Francie Donnelly RIP**, Ranaghan Rd., will
be held on Friday 28th August at 7.30pm in the Holy Rosary Church.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS

The First Anniversary Mass for **Georgina McGlone RIP**, Glocely Villars
will be held on Friday 21st August at 7.30pm in the Holy Rosary Church.

ANNIVERSARIES

Ballinascreen:
First Anniversary: Fr. Seamus O'Neill, Rory McCaffion, Moykeeran.
Patrick Murphy, Durrumary Rd. Marie Grogan, Drumderg Cottages.
John Rogers, Moynoneena Rd.

Desertmartin:

Fr. Seamus Shields, Tommy McGuckin, Sean Bradley,
Caroline McKenna, Alfie McGuckin, Mickey McAlister,
Joseph O'Hagan, Brian McVee, Gerrie Higgins, Pat Gormley, Kate Breen,
Philomena Regan, Bernard Regan.

BAPTISMS

We welcome into God's family through the Sacrament of Baptism:
Ceran Ann Hutchinson & Mary Ann Rose Hutchinson, Garforth, Leeds.
Darragh Richard Mort, Bramhall, Stockport

WEDDINGS

Congratulations and best wishes for the future to Danielle Convery and
Declan McCullagh who were recently married in St Eugene's Church,
Moynoneena.

PARISH COLLECTIONS	Ballinascreen	Desertmartin
Prisoners Collection	£1443	£1241
Remembrance Collection	£1705	£120

Thank you for your generous support which is greatly appreciated.

SUMMER DRAW 2026

Winners will be announced at end of the 6pm Vigil Mass in the Holy
Rosary Church. All proceeds will go to our church renovation fund for
the upkeep of all our churches in the parish.

**You may still purchase a ticket to be entered in the draw for the four
remaining weeks.**

Week 4 (22nd Aug): 1st Prize-£1000, 2nd Prize-£200, 3rd Prize-£100.

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Week 5 (15th Sept): 1st Prize-£2000, 2nd Prize-£500, 3rd Prize-£300.

PIONEER PRESENTATION

On Saturday August 22, at 7.30pm Mass in St Patrick's Church
Keenought, there will be a presentation of Pioneer Pins to Jubilarians
from both Desertmartin and Ballinascreen Parishes and to new members.
All welcome

BRADLEY'S CORNER VINTAGE TRACTOR RUN

On Sunday 16th August, Gathering from 12pm to 1.45pm departure,
All proceeds to Slieve Gallion Pre-School & FACTS Autism Support
Group. Small vintage tractors only!

KNOCKNAGIN HALL COMMITTEE AGM

The Committee warmly invites all members of the local community to
attend the **Annual General Meeting tomorrow night, Monday
17th August at 7.30pm Knocknagin Hall**. The Hall has been at the heart
of the local community since the early 1950s and current committee
members have served since 2011. It is important that a new generation of

volunteers comes forward with a wide range of skills, experience and
fresh ideas to help secure the future of the hall. Whatever your
experience, whether you can give a little time or a lot your involvement
would be greatly valued. With your support, it can continue to be a
welcoming, and sustainable community hub and continue to thrive for
future generations for many years to come. We look forward to
welcoming you to the AGM on **Monday 17th August at 7.30pm in
Knocknagin Hall**. Your attendance and support would be greatly
appreciated.

Chair Exercise: resumes on Tuesday mornings from 10am to 11am. A
fun and exciting way to get exercise, improve your fitness, health &
wellbeing. Everyone welcome Admission £4

Irish Dancing Lessons: recommences on Tuesday evenings 5.30pm to
7pm To register, contact Nicola: 07518 207458

Line Dancing Classes: commencing on Wednesday 12th August from
7.30pm. Suitable for all ages, from beginners to experts. A fun and
exciting way to get exercise, improve your mental health and at the same
time brush up on your dancing skills. Admission £5, everyone welcome

OUTDOOR SERVICE AT ST ANNE'S CHURCH

There will be an outdoor service at St Anne's Church, Sixtowns on
Sunday 23rd August at 4pm, conducted by Rural Dean, Rev Gary
Millar. The church has been closed since December 2023 and is still
awaiting repairs. All are very welcome to this outdoor service.

LEGION OF MARY

**'Embrace the Grace' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August
2026:** 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for
young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops,
food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De
Moorfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to
build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. This
event takes place on Saturday 29 August from 9.30am to 6pm with a
social afterwards. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite
website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be
directed towards dejeuneparis@gmail.com

ST JOSEPH MEN'S CAMINO

Every Camino changes as in ways we don't expect, every man needs
one. Join men from across Ireland on Saturday 12th September for a
25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The
day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch &
dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr. Mark Quinn. Open to men aged 18+.
Cost: €65 / student €55. Registration, accommodation & details:
www.droghedacaminowalkers.com. Enquiries: op.exangelisation@gmail.com

KILCROGANAGH CENTRE

Vintage Rally, Craft Fair & Family Fun Day, Sat 26th September,
11am-3pm More info, see Kilkronaghan Facebook / ring 02879627826

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND

Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential
Weekend on Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October at the Foculare Centre,
Corryhills, Co. Kildare. Deepen your communication, renew your love,
and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

ABIDE IN HIS LOVE WOMEN'S CONFERENCE

The Great Northern Hotel, Bandon, 20-22 November 2026. Join
women from across Ireland for a faith-filled weekend with inspiring
speakers Gavin, and more. A conference not to be missed! Register now:
<https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com>

LOST PIONEER PIN

A Gold Pioneer pin was lost at St Eugene's Church, Moynoneena, on
Friday 31st July. If found, please return it or contact the Parish Office at
02879628248. Thank you.

FOUND ITEM: Ladies Fleece

A Ladies Zip up Fleece has been found in Straw Graveyard. If this Fleece
belongs to you, please contact the Parish Office.

MICHAEL ENGLISH & BAND LIVE CONCERT

Join us for a rare and intimate evening with Michael
English, one of Ireland's most popular entertainers. This
exclusive acoustic performance takes place in a
beautiful church setting, blending majestic architecture
with uplifting music filled with hope, faith, and
community spirit. All proceeds from this special
fundraising concert will go toward supporting the
Parish of Desertmartin. The concert takes place on
Friday 2nd October, at 8pm in St. Patrick's Church,
Keenought. Tickets are €30 and available to buy from
Heron's Shop, Moynoneena Post Office, both Parish
Offices, or online with Eventbrite.



MICHAEL ENGLISH CONCERT

Any business or company who would like to be one of the sponsors for the
fundraising concert should contact Fr. Madden 02879628376 or email
either parish office desertmartinparish@gmail.com OR
ballinascreenparish@gmail.com. All sponsorship will be
greatly received and acknowledged.

PARISH BAPTISMS 2026

Ballinascreen Parish:
All bookings to be made via Parish Office on 02879628248 or
ballinascreenparish@gmail.com. Baptisms at 1pm on the following dates:
16th August, Straw
23rd August, Moynoneena
Sat 5th Sept, Sixtowns
4th Oct, Holy Rosary
1st Nov, Straw
30th August, Holy Rosary
13th Sept, Straw
Sat 17th Oct, Sixtowns

Desertmartin Parish:

To book a baptism, contact Fr. McCaul on 02879632196 or Desertmartin
Parish Office on 02879797047. Baptisms can be held in either church and
at 1.30 pm on the following dates:
September 6th & 27th 2026
October 4th & 18th 2026
December 6th & 20th 2026
February 7th & 21st 2027
April 4th & 18th 2027
November 8th & 22nd 2026
January 10th & 24th 2027
March 7th & 14th 2027

DERRY DIOCESAN SOCIETY

If you wish to enrol someone in the society, please contact the parish office.
The fee for a living or deceased member is €20.
The Vigil and Sunday Masses on 15th & 16th August in the Parish will be
offered for the deceased members of the Derry Diocesan Society.

NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN

Notices should be received by 1pm on Wednesday, preferably emailed to
ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

PARISH ANNIVERSARY MASS & MONTH'S MIND MASSES

If you wish to have a deceased loved one prayed for at any Anniversary
Friday Mass, please email their name to the Parish Office by 1pm on
Wednesday of the relevant week. Notices for First Anniversary and
Month's Mind Masses should be received before 1.00 pm on Wednesday of
the previous week so that they may be printed in the Bulletin the weekend
before the Anniversary Mass.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS

That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for justice [and] act
with integrity..." as they preach the message of God's salvation for
everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house of prayer for all the
peoples."